

Calculus

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Derivatives

Limits and derivatives

Definition 0.1 (Limit of a function at a point). Let f be a [function](#) defined at every point of an [open interval](#) around c , except possibly at c itself, and let L be a [real number](#). The **limit** of $f(x)$ as x approaches c is L , written $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = L$, if for every $\epsilon > 0$ there is a $\delta > 0$ such that

$$|f(x) - L| < \epsilon \quad \text{for every } x \text{ with } 0 < |x - c| < \delta.$$

Here $|\cdot|$ is the [absolute value](#). When such a real number L exists, the limit **exists**; otherwise, the limit does not exist. The value $f(c)$, if it is defined, plays no role.

Example 0.1 (The limit of $3x + 1$ at 2). $\lim_{x \rightarrow 2} (3x + 1) = 7$. Given $\epsilon > 0$, take $\delta = \epsilon/3$. For every x with $0 < |x - 2| < \delta$, using the [distributive law](#) in the second line,

$$\begin{aligned} |(3x + 1) - 7| &= |3x - 6| && \text{(subtract)} \\ &= |3(x - 2)| && \text{(distributive law)} \\ &= 3|x - 2| && (|3y| = 3|y|, \text{ since } 3 > 0) \\ &< 3 \cdot \frac{\epsilon}{3} && (|x - 2| < \delta = \epsilon/3) \\ &= \epsilon && \text{(multiply)} \end{aligned}$$

For example, with $\epsilon = 0.3$ and $\delta = 0.1$, the point $x = 2.05$ satisfies $0 < |2.05 - 2| < 0.1$, and $|(3 \cdot 2.05 + 1) - 7| = |7.15 - 7| = 0.15 < 0.3$.

Definition 0.2 (One-sided limits). Let f be a function and L a real number.

- The **right-hand limit** of f at c is L , written $\lim_{x \rightarrow c^+} f(x) = L$, if for every $\epsilon > 0$

there is a $\delta > 0$ such that $|f(x) - L| < \epsilon$ for every x with $c < x < c + \delta$.

- The **left-hand limit** of f at c is L , written $\lim_{x \rightarrow c^-} f(x) = L$, if for every $\epsilon > 0$ there is a $\delta > 0$ such that $|f(x) - L| < \epsilon$ for every x with $c - \delta < x < c$.

These are the **one-sided limits** of f at c . The limit $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x)$ (Definition 0.1) exists exactly when both one-sided limits exist and are equal, and then all three are equal.

Example 0.2 (One-sided limits of a step function). Let $H(x) = 1$ for $x \geq 0$ and $H(x) = 0$ for $x < 0$.

- $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} H(x) = 1$, because $H(x) = 1$ for every $x > 0$.
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} H(x) = 0$, because $H(x) = 0$ for every $x < 0$.

The one-sided limits differ, since $1 \neq 0$, so $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} H(x)$ does not exist.

Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist introduces limits and derivatives:

- [Calculating Limits](#)
- [Exercises on Limits](#)
- [Intro to Differential Calculus](#)
- [How Derivatives Arise from Limits](#)
- [Derivative Notation](#)

Definition 0.3 (Differentiable function). A function f is **differentiable at** $x = c$ if the limit (Definition 0.1)

$$f'(c) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(c+h) - f(c)}{h}$$

exists and is finite. The number $f'(c)$ is the derivative of f at c (Definition 0.4). (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 2.1, p. 100)

Example 0.3 (A differentiable function, and a limit that is not finite).

- $f(x) = x^2$ is differentiable at $c = 3$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{f(3+h) - f(3)}{h} &= \frac{(3+h)^2 - 3^2}{h} && \text{(substitute } f(x) = x^2\text{)} \\
&= \frac{9 + 6h + h^2 - 9}{h} && \text{(expand } (3+h)^2\text{)} \\
&= \frac{6h + h^2}{h} && \text{(cancel } 9 - 9\text{)} \\
&= 6 + h && \text{(divide by } h \neq 0\text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

which tends to the finite limit $f'(3) = 6$ as $h \rightarrow 0$.

- $g(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$ is not differentiable at $c = 0$: the quotient $\frac{g(h) - g(0)}{h} = \frac{\sqrt[3]{h}}{h} = \frac{1}{(\sqrt[3]{h})^2}$ grows without bound as $h \rightarrow 0$, so the limit is not finite.

Definition 0.4 (Derivative). If f is differentiable at c (Definition 0.3), the number $f'(c)$ is the **derivative** of f at c . The **derivative** of f is the function f' whose value at each x where f is differentiable is $f'(x)$. The derivative of f is also written $\frac{df}{dx}$ or $\frac{d}{dx}f(x)$.

Example 0.4 (The derivative of x^2). For $f(x) = x^2$, the computation in Example 0.3, with 3 replaced by any real number c , gives $\frac{f(c+h) - f(c)}{h} = 2c + h$, which tends to $2c$ as $h \rightarrow 0$. So the derivative of f is $f'(x) = 2x$. For example, $f'(3) = 6$ and $f'(-1) = -2$.

Derivative rules

Theorem 0.1 (Constant rule). *If c is constant with respect to x , then*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x}c = 0$$

Video

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has a video on this rule:

- [The Derivative of a Constant](#)

Theorem 0.2 (Constant multiple rule). *If a is constant with respect to x and y is a differentiable function of x , then:*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x}ay = a \frac{\partial y}{\partial x}$$

Video

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has a video on this rule:

- [The Constant Multiple Rule for Derivatives](#)

Theorem 0.3 (Power rule). *For every real number q and every $x > 0$, the derivative of the [power](#) x^q is:*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} x^q = qx^{q-1}$$

When q is a positive [integer](#), the same formula holds for every real x .

Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has videos on this rule, on the sum rule (the derivative of a sum is the sum of the derivatives), and on exercises that combine the rules so far:

- [The Power Rule for Derivatives](#)
- [The Sum Rule for Derivatives](#)
- [Exercises on Derivative Rules](#)

Theorem 0.4 (Derivative of natural logarithm). *For every $x > 0$, the derivative of the [natural logarithm](#) is:*

$$\log' \{x\} = \frac{1}{x} = x^{-1}$$

Theorem 0.5 (derivative of exponential). *For every real x , the derivative of the [exponential function](#) is:*

$$\exp' \{x\} = \exp \{x\}$$

Theorem 0.6 (Product rule). *If a and b are differentiable functions of x , then*

$$(ab)' = ab' + ba'$$

💡 Video

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has a video on this rule:

- [The Product Rule for Derivatives](#)

Theorem 0.7 (Quotient rule). *If a and b are differentiable functions of x and $b \neq 0$, then*

$$(a/b)' = a'/b - (a/b^2)b'$$

💡 Video

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has a video on this rule:

- [The Quotient Rule for Derivatives](#)

Theorem 0.8 (Chain rule). *If a is a differentiable function of b , and b is a differentiable function of c , then a is a differentiable function of c , and*

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{da}{dc} &= \frac{da}{db} \frac{db}{dc} \\ &= \frac{db}{dc} \frac{da}{db}\end{aligned}$$

or in [Lagrange’s notation](#), if g is differentiable at x and f is differentiable at $g(x)$, then for the [composition](#) $f \circ g$, with inner function g and outer function f :

$$(f(g(x)))' = g'(x)f'(g(x))$$

Corollary 0.1 (Chain rule for logarithms). *If f is differentiable at x and $f(x) > 0$, then*

$$\frac{d}{dx} \log\{f(x)\} = \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)}$$

📖 Proof

Proof. Apply Theorem [0.8](#) and Theorem [0.4](#):

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{d}{dx} \log\{f(x)\} &= f'(x) \cdot \log'\{f(x)\} && \text{(chain rule, with } g = f \text{ and outer function } \log) \\
&= f'(x) \cdot \frac{1}{f(x)} && \text{(derivative of } \log, \text{ valid because } f(x) > 0) \\
&= \frac{f'(x)}{f(x)} && \text{(multiply)}
\end{aligned}$$

□

💡 Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has videos on this rule and on exercises that combine it with the other rules:

- [The Chain Rule for Derivatives](#)
- [The Power Rule on a Function Chain](#)
- [Advanced Exercises on Derivative Rules](#)

Linear approximation

For a differentiable function f and a small step ϵ ,

$$f(w + \epsilon) \approx f(w) + \epsilon \frac{d}{dw} f(w) \tag{1}$$

Definition 0.5 (Flat point). A derivative of zero marks a **flat point** (also called a *stationary point*). A point where the derivative is zero or does not exist is a *critical point*.

Example 0.5 (Flat points and critical points).

- $f(w) = w^3$ has $f'(w) = 3w^2$, which is 0 at $w = 0$, so 0 is a flat point. It is neither a minimum nor a maximum: $f(w) < 0$ for $w < 0$ and $f(w) > 0$ for $w > 0$.
- $g(w) = |w|$ has no derivative at $w = 0$: the difference quotient $\frac{|h|-0}{h}$ is 1 for $h > 0$ and -1 for $h < 0$, so it has no limit. So 0 is a critical point but not a flat point.
- $h(w) = w^2$ has $h'(1) = 2 \neq 0$, so 1 is not a flat point.

The course website’s version of this page has an interactive plot [here](#).

Exercise 0.1 (Find the flat point, and check the approximation). Let $f(w) = w^2 - 4w + 7$.

1. Differentiate f .
2. Find the w at which f is flat, and say whether it is a minimum or a maximum.
3. Evaluate the derivative at $w = 1$, use Equation 1 to predict $f(1.01)$, and compare that prediction with the exact value.

Solution

Solution 0.1. **1.** Term by term:

$$\frac{df}{dw} = 2w - 4$$

2. Set it to zero: $2w - 4 = 0$ gives $w = 2$. It is a minimum. The coefficient on w^2 is positive, so the parabola opens upward; equivalently, the derivative is negative below $w = 2$ and positive above it, so the function falls into that point and rises out of it.

3. At $w = 1$ the derivative is $2(1) - 4 = -2$, so f is falling there. With $\epsilon = 0.01$, Equation 1 predicts a change of $(0.01)(-2) = -0.02$, from $f(1) = 1 - 4 + 7 = 4$ to 3.98. The exact value is

$$f(1.01) = (1.01)^2 - 4(1.01) + 7 = 1.0201 - 4.04 + 7 = 3.9801$$

a change of -0.0199 . The prediction is off by 0.0001 , which is ϵ^2 : the linear approximation drops everything of that order and smaller, so halving the step quarters the error. That trade is the whole bargain of gradient-based fitting. We take a step in the direction the derivative recommends, and the recommendation is trustworthy only as far as the step is small.

Integration

Integration is the inverse operation of differentiation: it recovers a function from its derivative and accumulates quantities such as areas, totals, and probabilities. We begin with antiderivatives, then state basic integration rules, and conclude with the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus and a worked example from probability.

Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist introduces integral calculus:

- [Intro to Integral Calculus](#)
- [What Integral Calculus Is](#)

Antiderivatives

Definition 0.6 (Antiderivative). A function F is an **antiderivative** of f on an interval I if:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} F(x) = f(x), \quad \forall x \in I$$

(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.1, pp. 248–249)

Definition 0.7 (Indefinite integral). The **indefinite integral** of f is the family of all antiderivatives (Definition 0.6) of f :

$$\int f(x) dx = F(x) + C$$

where F is any one antiderivative of f and C is an arbitrary constant of integration.
(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.1, pp. 248–249)

Example 0.6 (Antiderivative of a power function). For $f(x) = x^2$, an antiderivative is $F(x) = \frac{x^3}{3}$, since $\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \frac{x^3}{3} = x^2 = f(x)$.

Adding any constant C gives another antiderivative; for example, with $C = 7$, $F(x) = \frac{x^3}{3} + 7$ also satisfies $F'(x) = x^2$, since adding a constant does not change the derivative. $G(x) = x^3$ is not an antiderivative of x^2 : $G'(x) = 3x^2 \neq x^2$ for $x \neq 0$.

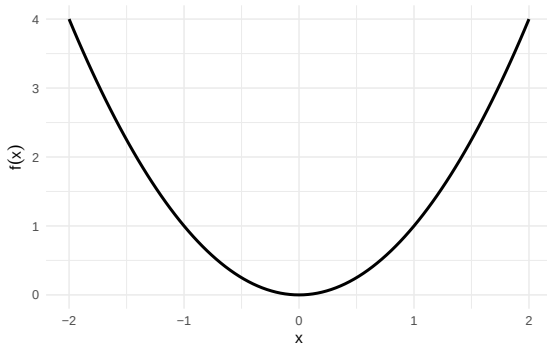
See Figure 1.

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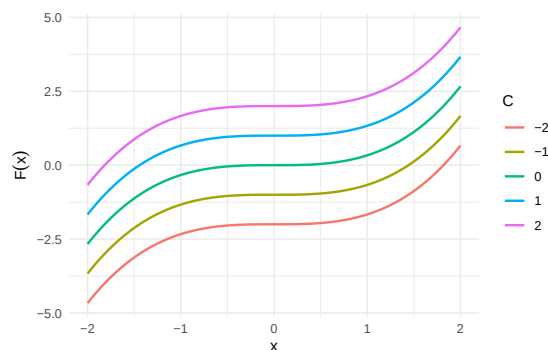
ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::geom_function(fun = \(x) {
    ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = expression(f(x)))
    ggplot2::theme_minimal()
  })
  x_seq <- seq(x_lim[1], x_lim[2], length.out = 200)
  df <- do.call(rbind, lapply(C_vals, \(C) {
    data.frame(
      x = x_seq,
      y = x_seq^3 / 3 + C,
      C = factor(C)
    )
  }))

ggplot2::ggplot(df, ggplot2::aes(x = x, y = y, color = C)) +
  ggplot2::geom_line(linewidth = 0.8) +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = expression(F(x)), color = C) +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()

```



(a) The function $f(x) = x^2$.



(b) Family of antiderivatives $F(x) = x^3/3 + C$.

Figure 1: The function $f(x) = x^2$ and five antiderivatives $F(x) = x^3/3 + C$ for $C \in \{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2\}$. Each antiderivative has the same derivative f ; they differ only by a vertical shift.

Theorem 0.9 (Basic integration rules). *Each antiderivative in the table is defined only up to an arbitrary constant C (see Definition 0.6); the table omits $+C$ from every row for brevity.*

Function $f(x)$	Antiderivative $F(x)$	Condition
c	cx	—
x^n	$\frac{x^{n+1}}{n+1}$	$n \neq -1$
$\frac{1}{x}$	$\log\{ x \}$	$x \neq 0$
e^x	e^x	(self-antiderivative)

e^{cx}	$\frac{1}{c}e^{cx}$	$c \neq 0$
$c \cdot f(x)$	$c \cdot F(x)$	—
$f(x) + g(x)$	$F(x) + G(x)$	—

The first two rows and the bottom two rows (linearity) are from (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.1, p. 250 “Basic Integration Rules”); $1/x$ is from (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 5.2, Theorem 5.5, p. 324); e^x and e^{cx} are from (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 5.4, Theorem 5.12, p. 346).

Example 0.7 (Antiderivative of $3x^2 - 1$). By the power rule ($n = 2$) and linearity from Theorem 0.9:

$$\int (3x^2 - 1) dx = 3 \cdot \frac{x^3}{3} - x + C = x^3 - x + C.$$

Verify by differentiating: $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(x^3 - x + C) = 3x^2 - 1 = f(x)$, as required.

Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has videos on these rules:

- [The Integral Calculus Rules](#)
- [Indefinite Integral Exercises](#)

Regularity Conditions

Definition 0.8 (Differentiable on an interval). A function f is **differentiable on** an interval if it is differentiable (Definition 0.3) at every interior point of the interval; at a closed endpoint, the appropriate one-sided derivative is used.
(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 2.1, p. 100)

Example 0.8 (Differentiable on one interval but not another).

- $f(x) = x^2$ is differentiable on $[0, 1]$: the computation of Example 0.3 with 3 replaced by any c gives $\frac{f(c+h)-f(c)}{h} = 2c + h$, which tends to $2c$, including the one-sided limits at the endpoints 0 and 1.
- $g(x) = \sqrt[3]{x}$ is differentiable on $[1, 2]$, but not on $[-1, 1]$: the point 0 is interior to $[-1, 1]$, and Example 0.3 shows g is not differentiable there.

Definition 0.9 (Continuous function). A function f is **continuous at** $x = c$ if all three conditions hold:

1. $f(c)$ is defined,
2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x)$ exists, and
3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = f(c)$.

(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 1.4, p. 73)

Example 0.9 (A continuous function, and one failure of each condition).

- $f(x) = x^2$ is continuous at $c = 1$: $f(1) = 1$ is defined, and $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} x^2 = 1 = f(1)$.
- $g(x) = \frac{x^2-1}{x-1}$ fails condition 1 at $c = 1$: $g(1)$ is not defined (it would divide by zero), even though $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} g(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 1} (x+1) = 2$ exists ($x^2 - 1 = (x-1)(x+1)$, and the factor $x-1$ cancels for $x \neq 1$).
- The step function $H(x) = 1$ for $x \geq 0$ and $H(x) = 0$ for $x < 0$ fails condition 2 at $c = 0$: values to the left are all 0 and values to the right are all 1, so $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} H(x)$ does not exist.
- $k(x) = x^2$ for $x \neq 1$, with $k(1) = 5$, fails condition 3 at $c = 1$: $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1} k(x) = 1$ exists but differs from $k(1) = 5$.

Definition 0.10 (Continuous on a closed interval). A function f is **continuous on** a closed interval $[a, b]$ if all three conditions hold:

1. f is continuous (Definition 0.9) at every point of the open interval (a, b) ,
2. $\lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x) = f(a)$, and
3. $\lim_{x \rightarrow b^-} f(x) = f(b)$.

(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 1.4, p. 73)

Example 0.10 (Continuity on $[0, 1]$ uses one-sided limits at the endpoints). Let $f(x) = \sqrt{x}$, the [square root](#), defined for $x \geq 0$. Because f is undefined for $x < 0$, only the right-hand limit of f at 0 makes sense, and Definition 0.10 asks only for that one-sided limit at the endpoint 0. Here f is continuous at every point of $(0, 1)$, $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} \sqrt{x} = 0 = f(0)$, and $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} \sqrt{x} = 1 = f(1)$, so f is continuous on $[0, 1]$ (Definition 0.10).

Example 0.11 (A function not continuous on $[0, 1]$). Let $f(x) = 0$ for $0 \leq x < 1$ and $f(1) = 2$. Conditions 1 and 2 of Definition 0.10 hold, but $\lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} f(x) = 0 \neq 2 = f(1)$, so condition 3 fails and f is not continuous on $[0, 1]$.

Definition 0.11 (Partition of an interval). A **partition** $\mathcal{P}$ of a closed interval $[a, b]$ is a finite list of points

$$a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b.$$

It splits $[a, b]$ into the n subintervals $[x_{i-1}, x_i]$, of widths $\Delta x_i \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} x_i - x_{i-1}$.
(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.3)

Example 0.12 (A partition of $[0, 1]$). The points $0 < 0.25 < 0.5 < 1$ form a partition of $[0, 1]$ with $n = 3$ subintervals, of widths $\Delta x_1 = 0.25$, $\Delta x_2 = 0.25$, and $\Delta x_3 = 0.5$.

Example 0.13 (Lists that are not partitions of $[0, 1]$).

- $0, 0.5, 0.25, 1$ is not a partition: the points are not increasing, since $0.5 > 0.25$.
- $0 < 0.5$ is not a partition of $[0, 1]$: its last point is 0.5 , not $b = 1$.

Definition 0.12 (Mesh of a partition). The **mesh** of a partition $\mathcal{P}$ (Definition 0.11) is its largest subinterval width,

$$\|\mathcal{P}\| \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \max_{i \in \{1, \dots, n\}} \Delta x_i,$$

where n is the number of subintervals of $\mathcal{P}$.
(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.3)

Example 0.14 (The mesh of a partition of $[0, 1]$). For the partition of $[0, 1]$ in Example 0.12, with widths $\Delta x_1 = 0.25$, $\Delta x_2 = 0.25$, and $\Delta x_3 = 0.5$, the mesh is the largest of these widths, $\|\mathcal{P}\| = 0.5$.

Definition 0.13 (Riemann integral). Let f be a **bounded** function on $[a, b]$. For each partition $\mathcal{P}$ of $[a, b]$ (Definition 0.11), choose a sample point x_i^* in each subinterval $[x_{i-1}, x_i]$. The **Riemann integral** of f over $[a, b]$ is the limit as the mesh (Definition 0.12) shrinks to zero:

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \lim_{\|\mathcal{P}\| \rightarrow 0} \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i^*) \Delta x_i,$$

when that limit exists and has the same value for every choice of the partitions and of the sample points x_i^* .
(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.3, p. 272)

Definition 0.14 (Riemann integrable). A bounded function f is **Riemann integrable** on $[a, b]$ if the sums $\sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i^*) \Delta x_i$, over partitions $\mathcal{P}$ of $[a, b]$ (Definition 0.11) with a sample point x_i^* in each subinterval $[x_{i-1}, x_i]$, approach a real-number limit as the mesh $\|\mathcal{P}\|$ (Definition 0.12) shrinks to zero, and that limit is the same for every choice of the partitions and of the sample points.

(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 4.3, p. 272)

Example 0.15 (A constant function is integrable). Let $f(x) = 2$ on $[0, 3]$. For every partition and every choice of sample points,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i^*) \Delta x_i &= \sum_{i=1}^n 2 \Delta x_i \quad (f \text{ is } 2 \text{ everywhere}) \\ &= 2 \sum_{i=1}^n \Delta x_i \quad (\text{factor out the constant}) \\ &= 2 \cdot (3 - 0) \quad (\text{the widths add up to the length of } [0, 3]) \\ &= 6, \quad (\text{multiply}) \end{aligned}$$

so the sums have the same limit, 6, for every choice: f is Riemann integrable on $[0, 3]$ (Definition 0.14), and $\int_0^3 2 \, dx = 6$ (Definition 0.13).

Remark 0.1 (Riemann integrable functions and Riemann integrals). A bounded function f is Riemann integrable on $[a, b]$ exactly when its Riemann integral $\int_a^b f(x) \, dx$ (Definition 0.13) exists; the integral is the common limit of the sums. For example, let $g(x) = 1$ when x is **rational** and $g(x) = 0$ when x is **irrational**, on $[0, 1]$. Every subinterval contains both rational and irrational points. Choosing every sample point rational gives $\sum_{i=1}^n 1 \cdot \Delta x_i = 1$ for every partition, because the widths Δx_i add up to the length $1 - 0 = 1$ of $[0, 1]$, and choosing every sample point irrational gives $\sum_{i=1}^n 0 \cdot \Delta x_i = 0$. The two limits differ, so g is not Riemann integrable on $[0, 1]$, and $\int_0^1 g(x) \, dx$ does not exist.

Definition 0.15 (Equal-width Riemann sum). For a bounded function f on $[a, b]$ and a positive integer n , split $[a, b]$ into n subintervals of equal width $\Delta x \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} (b - a)/n$, and let x_i^* be any point in the i -th subinterval. The **equal-width Riemann sum** is

$$S_n \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i^*) \Delta x.$$

Example 0.16 (An equal-width Riemann sum). Let $f(x) = x^2$ on $[0, 1]$, with $n = 2$, so $\Delta x = 1/2$, and take each sample point at the right end of its subinterval: $x_1^* = \frac{1}{2}$ and $x_2^* = 1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} S_2 &= f\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) \cdot \frac{1}{2} + f(1) \cdot \frac{1}{2} && \text{(equal-width Riemann sum with } n = 2\text{)} \\ &= \frac{1}{4} \cdot \frac{1}{2} + 1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} && \text{(evaluate } f(x) = x^2\text{)} \\ &= \frac{5}{8} && \text{(add)} \end{aligned}$$

Videos

Jon Krohn’s “Calculus for Machine Learning” YouTube playlist has videos on approximating an area by a sum of simple pieces, as a Riemann sum does, and on computing such sums in Python:

- [The Method of Exhaustion](#)
- [Numeric Integration with Python](#)

Before stating the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus, we record two prerequisite results. The usual statement of the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus assumes that the integrand f is continuous on $[a, b]$; continuity is [sufficient](#) there, though not necessary. The two results are “differentiability implies continuity”, which says where continuity comes from, and “continuity implies integrability”, which says what continuity buys us.

Theorem 0.10 (Differentiability implies continuity). *If f is differentiable at $x = c$, then f is continuous at $x = c$.
(Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 2.1, p. 106)*

Proof

Proof. Because $f'(c)$ exists, $f(c)$ is defined, and:

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} (f(c+h) - f(c)) &= \lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \left(\frac{f(c+h) - f(c)}{h} \cdot h \right) && \text{(multiply and divide by } h \neq 0\text{)} \\ &= \left(\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(c+h) - f(c)}{h} \right) \cdot \left(\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} h \right) && \text{(limit of a product, both limits exist)} \\ &= f'(c) \cdot 0 && \text{(definition of } f'(c)\text{)} \\ &= 0 && \text{(multiply)} \end{aligned}$$

So $\lim_{h \rightarrow 0} f(c+h) = f(c)$, which is $\lim_{x \rightarrow c} f(x) = f(c)$ with $x = c+h$; all three conditions of Definition [0.9](#) hold. □

Example 0.17 (Differentiable, hence continuous: $x^3 - x$). $f(x) = x^3 - x$ is differentiable everywhere (with derivative $f'(x) = 3x^2 - 1$), so by Theorem 0.10 it is continuous everywhere.

Example 0.18 (Continuous but not differentiable: $|x|$). The absolute-value function $f(x) = |x|$ is continuous at $x = 0$ ($\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} |x| = 0 = |0|$), but it is not differentiable at $x = 0$: the left-derivative is -1 and the right-derivative is $+1$. This counterexample shows that the converse of Theorem 0.10 fails: continuity does not imply differentiability. See Figure 2.

```
ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::geom_function(fun = abs, xlim = c(-2, 2), linewidth = 1) +
  ggplot2::geom_point(ggplot2::aes(x = 0, y = 0), size = 3) +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = expression(f(x) == abs(x))) +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()
```

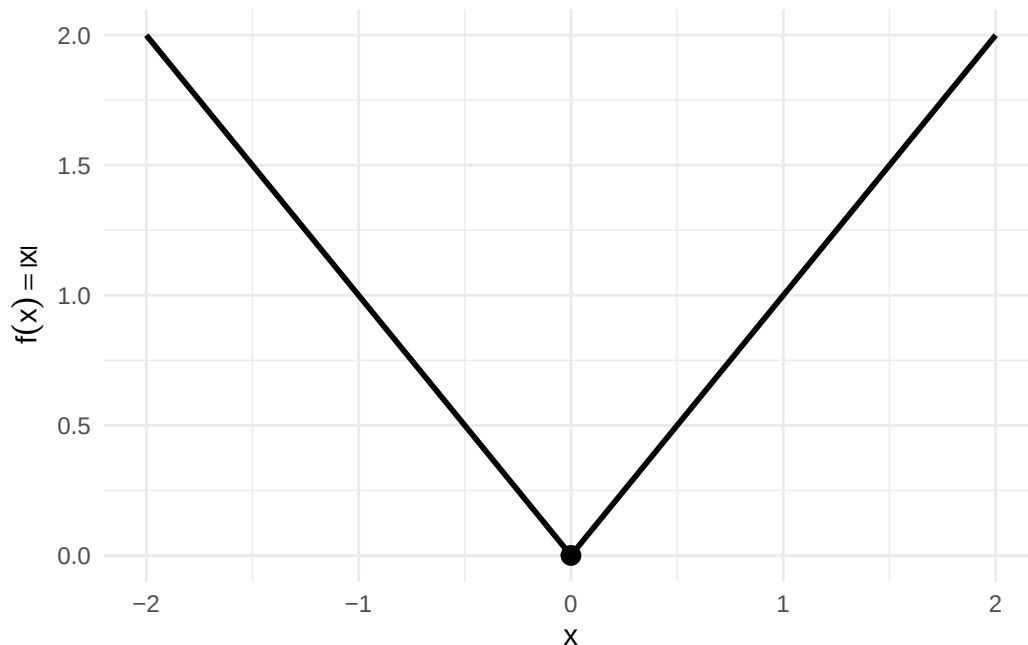


Figure 2: $f(x) = |x|$ has a sharp corner at $x = 0$ (not differentiable there) but is continuous everywhere: no gaps or jumps.

Theorem 0.11 (Continuity implies integrability). *If f is continuous on the closed interval*

$[a, b]$, then f is integrable on $[a, b]$ (i.e., the Riemann integral $\int_a^b f(x) dx$ exists and is finite).

(Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 4.4, p. 272)

Example 0.19 (Continuous, hence integrable: polynomials). Every polynomial is continuous on $\mathbb{R}$, so by Theorem 0.11 every polynomial is integrable on every closed interval $[a, b]$.

Example 0.20 (Integrable but not continuous: a step function). Let $f(x) = 0$ for $x < \frac{1}{2}$ and $f(x) = 1$ for $x \geq \frac{1}{2}$. Then f is discontinuous at $x = \frac{1}{2}$, but it is integrable on $[0, 1]$:

$$\int_0^1 f(x) dx = \int_0^{1/2} 0 dx + \int_{1/2}^1 1 dx = 0 + \frac{1}{2} = \frac{1}{2}.$$

This counterexample shows that the converse of Theorem 0.11 fails: integrability does not imply continuity. See Figure 3.

```

step_df <- data.frame(
  x = c(0, 0.5, 0.5, 1),
  y = c(0, 0, 1, 1),
  segment = c("left", "left", "right", "right")
)

ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::geom_rect(
    ggplot2::aes(xmin = 0.5, xmax = 1, ymin = 0, ymax = 1),
    fill = "steelblue", alpha = 0.3
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_line(
    data = step_df,
    ggplot2::aes(x = x, y = y, group = segment),
    linewidth = 1
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_point(ggplot2::aes(x = 0.5, y = 0), shape = 1, size = 3) +
  ggplot2::geom_point(ggplot2::aes(x = 0.5, y = 1), shape = 16, size = 3) +
  ggplot2::scale_x_continuous(
    breaks = c(0, 0.5, 1),
    labels = c("0", "1/2", "1")
  ) +
  ggplot2::scale_y_continuous(limits = c(-0.1, 1.2)) +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = "f(x)") +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()

```

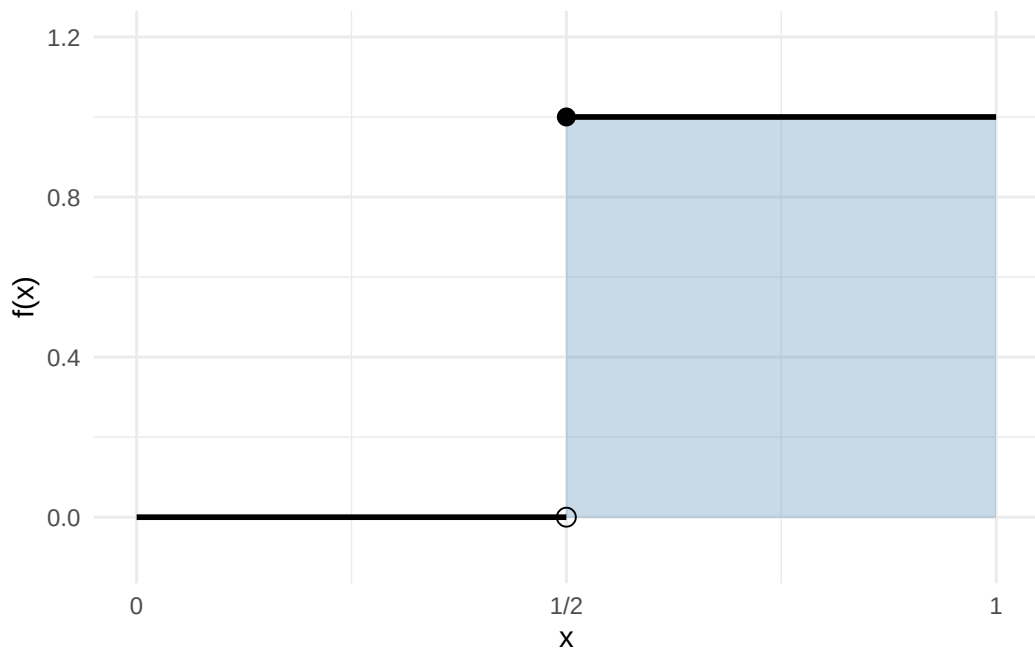


Figure 3: Step function: $f(x) = 0$ on $[0, \frac{1}{2})$ (open circle at the jump) and $f(x) = 1$ on $[\frac{1}{2}, 1]$ (filled circle). The shaded rectangle has area $\frac{1}{2}$, matching the integral computed in Example 0.20.

Together, Theorem 0.10 and Theorem 0.11 establish the chain:

$$\text{differentiable on } [a, b] \Rightarrow \text{continuous on } [a, b] \Rightarrow \text{integrable on } [a, b]$$

Example 0.18 and Example 0.20 show that neither implication reverses in general.

Theorem 0.12 (Equal-width Riemann sums converge to the integral). *If f is Riemann integrable on $[a, b]$ (Definition 0.14), then for every choice of the sample points x_i^* , the equal-width Riemann sums (Definition 0.15) converge to the integral:*

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} S_n = \int_a^b f(x) dx.$$

i Proof

Proof. The n equal-width subintervals form a partition of $[a, b]$ whose mesh (Definition 0.12) is $(b - a)/n$, which goes to 0 as $n \rightarrow \infty$. So S_n is one of the sums in the limit that defines the integral (Definition 0.13), along a sequence of partitions whose mesh goes to 0, and a limit that has the same value for every choice of partitions has that value along this sequence too. $\square$

Example 0.21 (Equal-width sums for $\int_0^1 x dx$). Let $f(x) = x$ on $[0, 1]$, which is continuous and so Riemann integrable (Theorem 0.11), and take each sample point at the right end of its subinterval, $x_i^* = i/n$. With $\Delta x = 1/n$:

$$\begin{aligned} S_n &= \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{i}{n} \cdot \frac{1}{n} && \text{(equal-width Riemann sum with } x_i^* = i/n) \\ &= \frac{1}{n^2} \sum_{i=1}^n i && \text{(factor out } 1/n^2) \\ &= \frac{1}{n^2} \cdot \frac{n(n+1)}{2} && \text{(sum of the first } n \text{ integers)} \\ &= \frac{n+1}{2n} && \text{(cancel one factor of } n) \end{aligned}$$

So $S_{10} = 0.55$, $S_{100} = 0.505$, $S_{1000} = 0.5005$, and $S_n \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$. By Theorem 0.12, $\int_0^1 x dx = \frac{1}{2}$.

Fundamental Theorem of Calculus

Theorem 0.13 (Fundamental Theorem of Calculus). *Let f be a continuous function on a closed interval $[a, b]$.*

Part 1 (Derivative of an integral). *Define $F(x) = \int_a^x f(t) dt$ for $x \in [a, b]$. Then F is differentiable and:*

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \int_a^x f(t) dt = f(x) \quad (2)$$

Note

Continuity on all of $[a, b]$ is a sufficient condition. More generally, Part 1 holds at any individual point x where f is integrable on $[a, b]$ (see Definition 0.14) and continuous at x (see Definition 0.9), even if f has jump discontinuities elsewhere (Rudin 1976, Theorem 6.20, p. 133).

(Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 4.11, p. 288)

Part 2 (Evaluation theorem). *The F here may be any antiderivative of f — not just the accumulation function from Part 1. If F is an antiderivative of f on $[a, b]$ (i.e., $\frac{\partial}{\partial x} F(x) = f(x)$ for all $x \in [a, b]$), then:*

$$\int_a^b f(x) dx = F(b) - F(a) \quad (3)$$

Equivalently, with b replaced by a variable upper limit x , integrating the derivative of F recovers the net change in F :

$$\int_a^x F'(t) dt = F(x) - F(a) \quad (4)$$

or equivalently in Leibniz notation:

$$\int_a^x \frac{dF}{dt} dt = F(x) - F(a)$$

(Banner 2007, chap. 18; Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 4.9, p. 282)

The two parts of the FTC together express that **differentiation and integration are inverse operations**:

- Part 1: differentiating the integral of f recovers f (Equation 2).
- Part 2: the integral of f over $[a, b]$ equals the difference of any antiderivative's values at the endpoints (Equation 3), which rearranges to “integrating the derivative of F recovers the net change in F ” (Equation 4).

The standard form of the FTC assumes f is continuous on $[a, b]$; continuity is *sufficient* but not strictly necessary (see the callout note inside Theorem 0.13 for the more general statement). Since differentiability implies continuity (Theorem 0.10), the FTC applies in particular whenever f is differentiable — a common situation in applied statistics.

Example 0.22 (FTC Part 1 visualized: accumulation function for $f(t) = 2t$). Take $f(t) = 2t$ on $[0, 2]$. The accumulation function from 0 is

$$F(x) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \int_0^x 2t \, dt = [t^2]_{t=0}^{t=x} = x^2 - 0^2 = x^2,$$

so $F(x) = x^2$, and indeed $F'(x) = 2x = f(x)$, as Theorem 0.13 Part 1 predicts. Figure 4 shows the integrand on the left (shaded area equals $F(x)$ at each x) and the accumulation function $F(x) = x^2$ on the right (its slope at x equals $f(x) = 2x$).

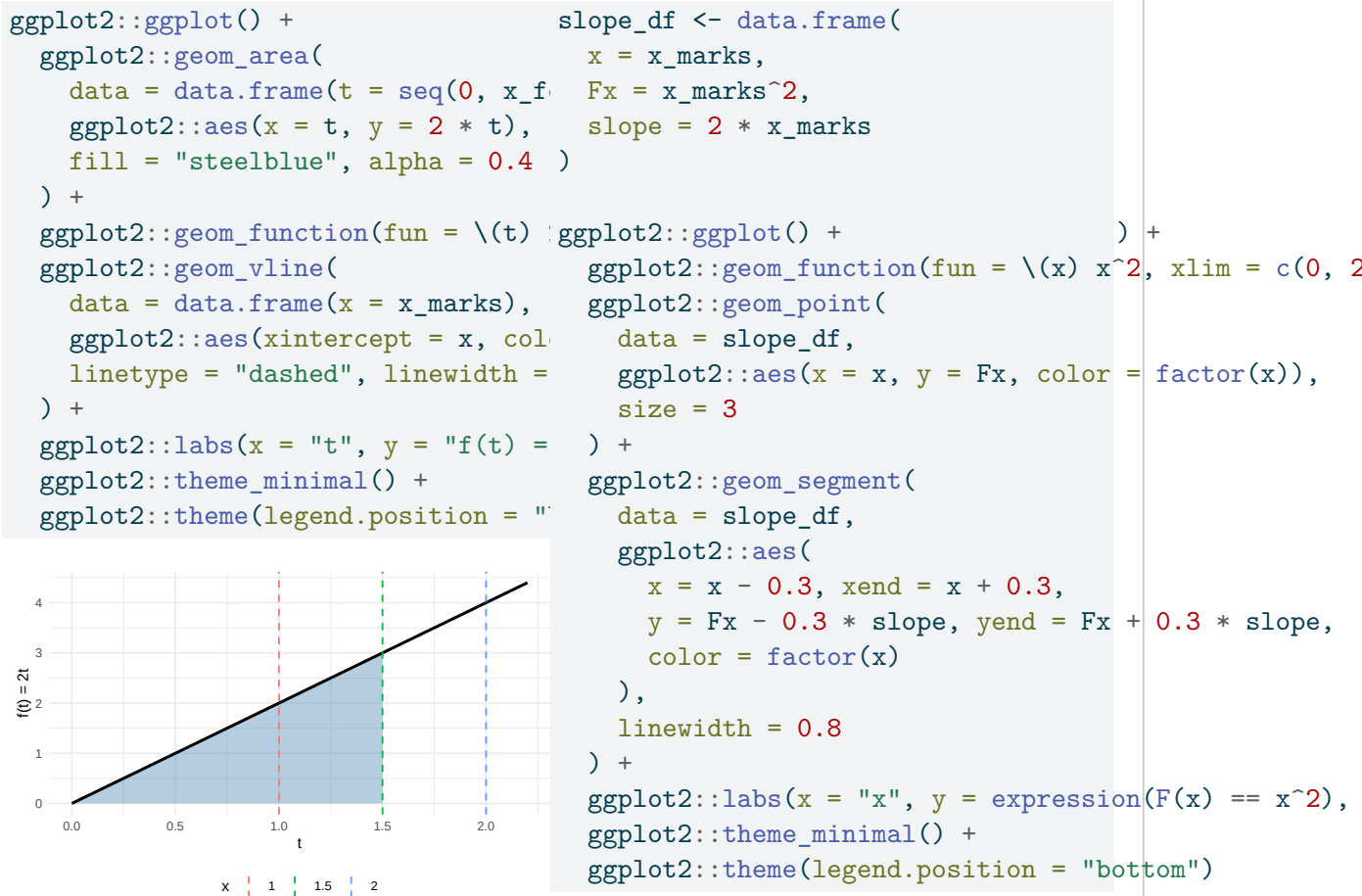


Figure 4: Left: $f(t) = 2t$; the shaded area $\int_0^{1.5} 2t \, dt = F(1.5) = 2.25$; vertical lines mark $x \in \{1, 1.5, 2\}$. Right: $F(x) = x^2$; for each marked x , the tangent slope equals $f(x) = 2x$.

Example 0.23 (CDF and PDF of the exponential distribution). In what follows, f denotes the PDF and F the CDF — the same letters as the antiderivative pair in Definition 0.6, because the FTC will show F is exactly an antiderivative of f .

Let T be a [random variable](#) with the exponential distribution with rate parameter $\lambda > 0$. Its [probability density function \(PDF\)](#) is (Kleinbaum and Klein 2012, sec. II, p. 295, “Survival and Hazard Functions for Selected Distributions”):

$$f(t) = \lambda e^{-\lambda t}, \quad t \geq 0$$

FTC Part 2 gives the [cumulative distribution function \(CDF\)](#), $F(t) = P(T \leq t)$, from the PDF. Apply the e^{cx} rule from Theorem 0.9 with $c = -\lambda$ to antidifferentiate the integrand:

$$\begin{aligned} F(t) &= \int_0^t \lambda e^{-\lambda u} du && \text{(the CDF integrates the PDF)} \\ &= \left[\lambda \cdot \frac{1}{-\lambda} e^{-\lambda u} \right]_{u=0}^{u=t} && \text{(FTC Part 2, with the } e^{cx} \text{ rule)} \\ &= [(-1)e^{-\lambda u}]_{u=0}^{u=t} && (\lambda/(-\lambda) = -1) \\ &= [-e^{-\lambda u}]_{u=0}^{u=t} && \text{(multiply by } -1) \\ &= -e^{-\lambda t} - (-e^0) && \text{(evaluate at the limits)} \\ &= -e^{-\lambda t} - (-1) && (e^0 = 1) \\ &= 1 - e^{-\lambda t} && \text{(rearrange)} \end{aligned}$$

FTC Part 1 recovers the PDF from the CDF:

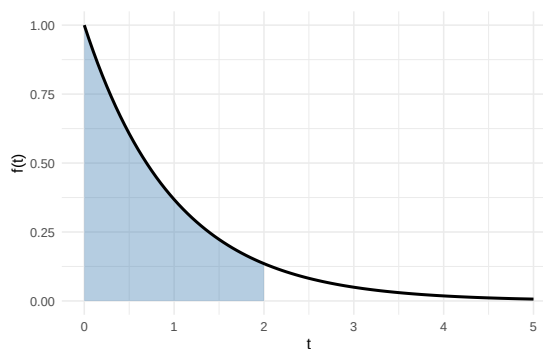
$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial t} F(t) &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} (1 - e^{-\lambda t}) && \text{(substitute } F) \\ &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} 1 - \frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{-\lambda t} && \text{(derivative of a difference)} \\ &= 0 - \frac{\partial}{\partial t} e^{-\lambda t} && \text{(constant rule)} \\ &= 0 - e^{-\lambda t} \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial t} (-\lambda t) && \text{(chain rule, with inner function } -\lambda t) \\ &= 0 - e^{-\lambda t} \cdot (-\lambda) && \text{(constant multiple rule)} \\ &= \lambda e^{-\lambda t} && \text{(simplify)} \\ &= f(t) && \text{(definition of } f) \end{aligned}$$

For a concrete instance: with $\lambda = 1$ (standard exponential), the probability that $T \leq 2$ is:

$$F(2) = 1 - e^{-1 \cdot 2} = 1 - e^{-2} \approx 1 - 0.135 = 0.865$$

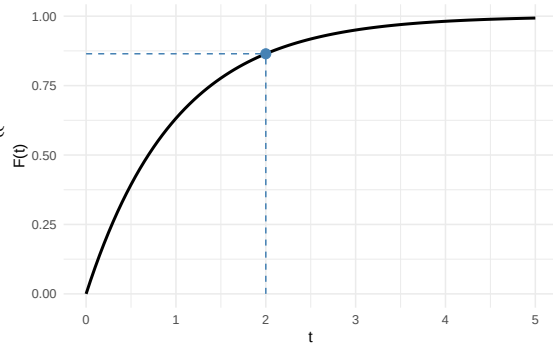
See Figure 5.

```
ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::geom_area(
    data = data.frame(t = seq(0, t_f, 0.1),
                      y = lambda * exp(-lambda * t)),
    fill = "steelblue", alpha = 0.4
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_function(
    fun = \(t) lambda * exp(-lambda * t),
    xlim = c(0, t_max), linewidth = 1
  ) +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "t", y = "f(t)")
ggplot2::theme_minimal()
```



(a) PDF with $\lambda = 1$; shaded area equals $F(2) \approx 0.865$.

```
ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::geom_function(
    fun = \(t) 1 - exp(-lambda * t),
    xlim = c(0, t_max), linewidth = 1
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_point(
    ggplot2::aes(x = t_focus, y = F_at_focus),
    size = 3, color = "steelblue"
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_segment(
    ggplot2::aes(x = t_focus, xend = t_focus, y = 0, yend = F_at_focus),
    linetype = "dashed", color = "steelblue"
  ) +
  ggplot2::geom_segment(
    ggplot2::aes(x = 0, xend = t_focus, y = F_at_focus, yend = F_at_focus),
    linetype = "dashed", color = "steelblue"
  ) +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "t", y = "F(t)") +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()
```



(b) CDF with $\lambda = 1$; point marks $F(2) \approx 0.865$.

Figure 5: Exponential distribution with $\lambda = 1$. Left: the PDF $f(t) = \lambda e^{-\lambda t}$; the shaded area under the curve from 0 to 2 equals $F(2) \approx 0.865$. Right: the CDF $F(t) = 1 - e^{-\lambda t}$; the dashed lines mark the value $F(2)$ computed via FTC Part 2.

💡 Videos

Jon Krohn's "Calculus for Machine Learning" YouTube playlist has videos on evaluating definite integrals:

- [Definite Integrals](#)
- [Definite Integral Exercise](#)

Double Integrals

The **Fubini–Tonelli theorem** states conditions under which the order of integration in a double integral can be exchanged. We state two versions: the Riemann version (Theorem 0.14) is what applied courses usually use for double integrals of continuous functions on simple regions; the σ -finite measure-theoretic version (Theorem 0.15) is included to make the [joint-distribution form](#) corollary in *Probability for Data Science* follow from a stated theorem rather than from an aside.

Definition 0.16 (Double integral). Let f be a bounded function on a closed, bounded plane region $R \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$. Cover R with a grid of rectangles, keep the n rectangles that lie entirely inside R , with areas $\Delta A_1, \dots, \Delta A_n$, and choose a point (x_i, y_i) in the i -th rectangle. The **double integral** of f over R is

$$\iint_R f(x, y) dA \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \lim_{\|\Delta\| \rightarrow 0} \sum_{i=1}^n f(x_i, y_i) \Delta A_i,$$

where $\|\Delta\|$ is the length of the longest diagonal among the n rectangles, when that limit exists and has the same value for every choice of grids and of the points (x_i, y_i) . The symbol dA stands for an element of area.

(Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 14.2)

Example 0.24 (The double integral of 1 is an area). Let $f(x, y) = 1$ on the rectangle $R = [0, 2] \times [0, 3]$. Every sum in Definition 0.16 adds up the areas of rectangles inside R , and those sums approach the area of R as the grid gets finer, so $\iint_R 1 dA = 2 \cdot 3 = 6$.

Definition 0.17 (Iterated integral). An **iterated integral** is an integral of an integral:

$$\int_a^b \int_{g_1(x)}^{g_2(x)} f(x, y) dy dx \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \int_a^b \left(\int_{g_1(x)}^{g_2(x)} f(x, y) dy \right) dx$$

That is, integrate over the inner variable (y) first, holding the outer variable (x) fixed, and then integrate the result over the outer variable. The inner limits $g_1(x)$ and $g_2(x)$ may depend on the outer variable, or be constants c and d , as in $\int_a^b \int_c^d f(x, y) dy dx$. Iterated integrals in the other order, $\int \int \dots dx dy$, are defined the same way with the roles of x and y swapped.

Example 0.25 (An iterated integral). Integrating over y first, then x :

$$\begin{aligned}
 \int_0^1 \int_0^2 xy \, dy \, dx &= \int_0^1 \left(\int_0^2 xy \, dy \right) dx && \text{(definition of the iterated integral)} \\
 &= \int_0^1 x \left(\int_0^2 y \, dy \right) dx && (x \text{ is constant in } y) \\
 &= \int_0^1 x \left[\frac{y^2}{2} \right]_{y=0}^{y=2} dx && \text{(antiderivative of } y) \\
 &= \int_0^1 2x \, dx && \text{(evaluate at the limits)} \\
 &= [x^2]_{x=0}^{x=1} && \text{(antiderivative of } 2x) \\
 &= 1 && \text{(evaluate at the limits)}
 \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 0.14 (Fubini's theorem (Riemann version)). Let f be **continuous** on a plane region $R \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$.

1. **Vertically simple region.** If R is defined by $a \leq x \leq b$ and $g_1(x) \leq y \leq g_2(x)$, where g_1 and g_2 are continuous on $[a, b]$, then

$$\iint_R f(x, y) \, dA = \int_a^b \int_{g_1(x)}^{g_2(x)} f(x, y) \, dy \, dx.$$

2. **Horizontally simple region.** If R is defined by $c \leq y \leq d$ and $h_1(y) \leq x \leq h_2(y)$, where h_1 and h_2 are continuous on $[c, d]$, then

$$\iint_R f(x, y) \, dA = \int_c^d \int_{h_1(y)}^{h_2(y)} f(x, y) \, dx \, dy.$$

When R can be described both ways, the two iterated integrals are equal — so the order of integration can be exchanged.

(Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 14.2, p. 982)

Example 0.26 (Changing the order of integration for a non-rectangular region). Adapted from (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 14.2, Example 4, pp. 984–985).

Let X and Y be independent Uniform(0, 1) **random variables**, with **joint density** $f(x, y) = 1$ on the unit square $[0, 1]^2$. Define the function $g(x, y) = e^{-x^2} \mathbb{1}(y \leq x)$, where e is **Euler's number**, and compute its **expectation** $E[g(X, Y)]$.

Because the joint density equals 1 on $[0, 1]^2$, this expectation is the double integral of g

over the unit square:

$$\mathbb{E}[g(X, Y)] = \iint_{[0,1]^2} g(x, y) \, dA.$$

The indicator factor $\mathbb{1}(y \leq x)$ equals 1 on the triangular region where $y \leq x$ and 0 elsewhere, so only that region, namely $D = \{(x, y) : x \in [0, 1], y \in [0, x]\}$ (Figure 6), contributes, and there $g(x, y) = e^{-x^2}$:

$$\mathbb{E}[g(X, Y)] = \iint_D e^{-x^2} \, dA.$$

```

region <- data.frame(x = c(0, 1, 1), y = c(0, 0, 1))
ggplot2::ggplot(region, ggplot2::aes(x = x, y = y)) +
  ggplot2::geom_polygon(
    fill = "steelblue", alpha = 0.4, color = "black", linewidth = 0.7
  ) +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "text", x = 0.65, y = 0.28, label = "D", size = 8, fontface = "italic"
  ) +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "text", x = 0.36, y = 0.52, label = "y == x",
    parse = TRUE, angle = 45
  ) +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "text", x = 1.08, y = 0.5, label = "x == 1",
    parse = TRUE, angle = 90, hjust = 0.5
  ) +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "text", x = 0.5, y = -0.1, label = "y == 0", parse = TRUE
  ) +
  ggplot2::scale_x_continuous(breaks = c(0, 0.5, 1), limits = c(-0.1, 1.3)) +
  ggplot2::scale_y_continuous(breaks = c(0, 0.5, 1), limits = c(-0.2, 1.2)) +
  ggplot2::coord_equal() +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = "y") +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()

```

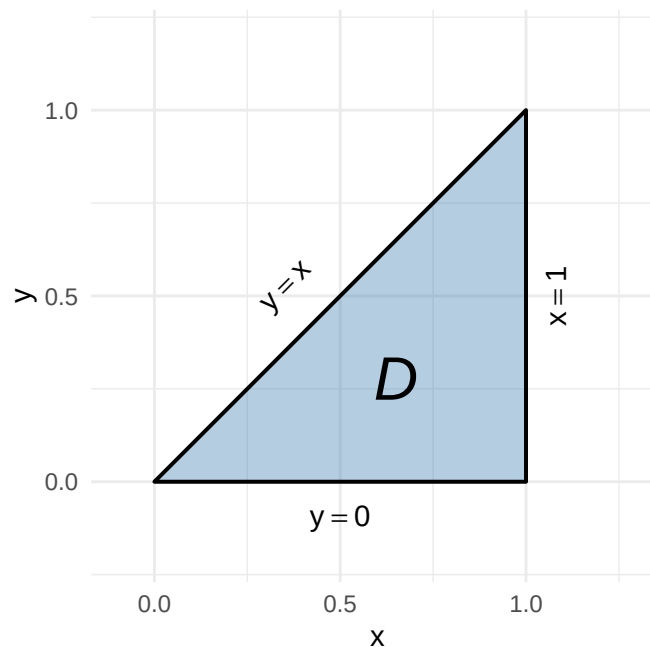


Figure 6: Triangular integration region $D = \{(x, y) : x \in [0, 1], y \in [0, x]\}$, bounded below by $y = 0$, above-left by $y = x$, and on the right by $x = 1$.

Order $dx\,dy$ is intractable. Re-describing D as $D = \{(x, y) : y \in [0, 1], x \in [y, 1]\}$, the inner integral is

$$\int_y^1 e^{-x^2} dx,$$

which has no elementary antiderivative.

Order $dy\,dx$ works. Applying Theorem 0.14 Part 1 (e^{-x^2} is continuous and D is the vertically simple region $x \in [0, 1], y \in [0, x]$):

$$\begin{aligned} \iint_D e^{-x^2} dA &= \int_0^1 \int_0^x e^{-x^2} dy\,dx && \text{(Fubini, vertically simple region)} \\ &= \int_0^1 e^{-x^2} \left(\int_0^x dy \right) dx && (e^{-x^2} \text{ is constant in } y) \\ &= \int_0^1 x e^{-x^2} dx && (\int_0^x dy = x) \end{aligned}$$

To antidifferentiate $x e^{-x^2}$, let $u = x^2$ be the inner function. By the chain rule (Theorem 0.8), with $\frac{du}{dx} = 2x$,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dx} \left(-\frac{1}{2} e^{-u} \right) &= -\frac{1}{2} e^{-u} \cdot (-1) \cdot \frac{du}{dx} && \text{(chain rule)} \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} e^{-x^2} \cdot (-1) \cdot 2x && \text{(substitute } u = x^2 \text{ and } du/dx = 2x) \\ &= x e^{-x^2} && \text{(multiply)} \end{aligned}$$

so $-\frac{1}{2} e^{-x^2}$ is an antiderivative of $x e^{-x^2}$, and

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 x e^{-x^2} dx &= \left[-\frac{1}{2} e^{-x^2} \right]_0^1 && \text{(FTC Part 2)} \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} (e^{-1} - e^0) && \text{(evaluate at the limits)} \\ &= -\frac{1}{2} (e^{-1} - 1) && (e^0 = 1) \\ &= \frac{1 - e^{-1}}{2} && \text{(distribute } -\frac{1}{2}) \\ &= \frac{e - 1}{2e} && \text{(multiply numerator and denominator by } e) \\ &\approx 0.316 \end{aligned}$$

The solid whose volume equals this integral is shown in Figure 7.

(This 3D surface is interactive; see the HTML or slide version of this page to view it.)

Figure 7: Surface $z = e^{-x^2}$ over the region $D = \{(x, y) : x \in [0, 1], y \in [0, x]\}$. The surface depends only on x (constant in y), so for each x the inner integral over $y \in [0, x]$ contributes $x \cdot e^{-x^2}$.

Example 0.27 (When conditions fail: a counterexample). The conditions in Theorem 0.14 are not merely technical — when they fail, iterated integrals can exist yet disagree.

Let

$$f(x, y) = \frac{x^2 - y^2}{(x^2 + y^2)^2}$$

on the unit square $R = [0, 1] \times [0, 1]$. Strictly, f is defined on $R \setminus \{(0, 0)\}$: the denominator vanishes at the origin, so f is undefined there (we return to this point in the condition check).

Integrating y first, then x :

Using $\frac{\partial}{\partial y} \frac{y}{x^2 + y^2} = \frac{x^2 - y^2}{(x^2 + y^2)^2}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 \int_0^1 f(x, y) dy dx &= \int_0^1 \left[\frac{y}{x^2 + y^2} \right]_{y=0}^{y=1} dx \\ &= \int_0^1 \frac{1}{x^2 + 1} dx \\ &= [\arctan(x)]_0^1 \\ &= \frac{\pi}{4} \end{aligned}$$

Integrating x first, then y :

Using $\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(-\frac{x}{x^2 + y^2} \right) = \frac{x^2 - y^2}{(x^2 + y^2)^2}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 \int_0^1 f(x, y) dx dy &= \int_0^1 \left[-\frac{x}{x^2 + y^2} \right]_{x=0}^{x=1} dy \\ &= \int_0^1 \left(-\frac{1}{1 + y^2} \right) dy \\ &= -[\arctan(y)]_0^1 \\ &= -\frac{\pi}{4} \end{aligned}$$

Conclusion: $\frac{\pi}{4} \neq -\frac{\pi}{4}$, so the two iterated integrals are unequal. Theorem 0.14 does not apply here.

Why Theorem 0.14's condition fails: Theorem 0.14 requires f to be **continuous** on R . The denominator $(x^2 + y^2)^2$ vanishes at the origin $(0, 0) \in R$, so f is *not even defined*

there — let alone continuous — and the theorem does not apply.

(Wikipedia contributors 2024)

The surface, and the singularity at the origin responsible for the failure, are shown in Figure 8.

(This 3D surface is interactive; see the HTML or slide version of this page to view it.)

Figure 8: Surface $f(x, y) = (x^2 - y^2)/(x^2 + y^2)^2$ on $[0, 1]^2$, sampled away from the origin and clipped to $[-50, 50]$ for display. The function diverges to $+\infty$ along the x -axis (red ridge, $f > 0$ when $|x| > |y|$) and to $-\infty$ along the y -axis (blue ridge, $f < 0$ when $|y| > |x|$). The singularity at $(0, 0)$ is why f is not continuous on R and Theorem 0.14 does not apply.

Corollary 0.2 (Continuous functions on a rectangle (corollary of Theorem 0.14)). *If $f : [a, b] \times [c, d] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is **continuous** on the closed bounded rectangle $[a, b] \times [c, d]$, then:*

$$\begin{aligned} \int_a^b \left(\int_c^d f(x, y) dy \right) dx &= \int_c^d \left(\int_a^b f(x, y) dx \right) dy \\ &= \iint_{[a, b] \times [c, d]} f(x, y) dA. \end{aligned}$$

(Larson and Edwards 2018, Theorem 14.2, p. 982)

i Proof

Proof. A closed bounded rectangle $[a, b] \times [c, d]$ is both vertically simple (with $g_1 \equiv c$, $g_2 \equiv d$) and horizontally simple (with $h_1 \equiv a$, $h_2 \equiv b$). Applying both parts of Theorem 0.14 to f on this rectangle gives the two iterated forms shown. $\square$

Example 0.28 (Evaluating a double integral on a rectangle). Structure adapted from (Larson and Edwards 2018, sec. 14.2, Example 2, pp. 982–983); the integrand $x^2 + y^2$ is original, chosen so the integral equals $E[g(X, Y)]$ for $g(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$.

Let X and Y be independent Uniform(0, 1) **random variables**, with **joint density** $f(x, y) = 1$ on the unit square $R = \{(x, y) : x \in [0, 1], y \in [0, 1]\}$ (Figure 9). Define the function $g(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$, and compute its **expectation** $E[g(X, Y)]$.

Because the joint density equals 1 on R , this expectation is the double integral of g over R :

$$E[g(X, Y)] = \iint_R (x^2 + y^2) dA.$$

```

ggplot2::ggplot() +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "rect", xmin = 0, xmax = 1, ymin = 0, ymax = 1,
    fill = "steelblue", alpha = 0.4, color = "black", linewidth = 0.7
  ) +
  ggplot2::annotate(
    "text", x = 0.5, y = 0.5, label = "R", size = 8, fontface = "italic"
  ) +
  ggplot2::scale_x_continuous(breaks = c(0, 1), limits = c(-0.15, 1.25)) +
  ggplot2::scale_y_continuous(breaks = c(0, 1), limits = c(-0.15, 1.25)) +
  ggplot2::coord_equal() +
  ggplot2::labs(x = "x", y = "y") +
  ggplot2::theme_minimal()

```

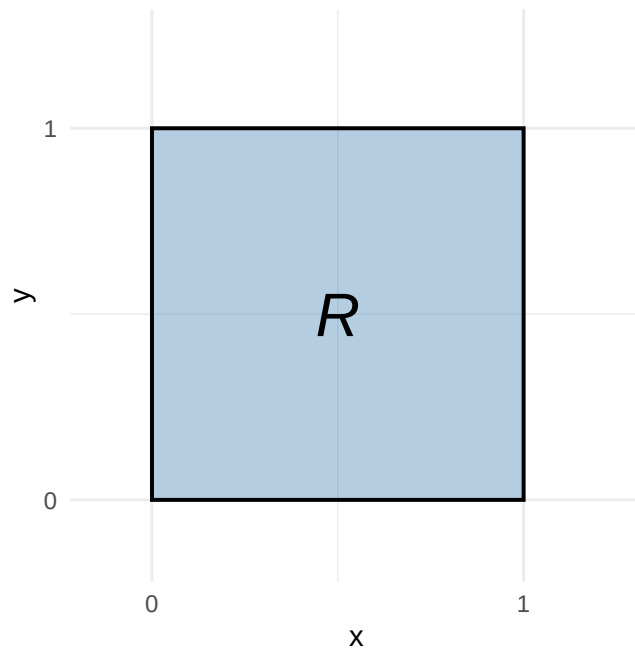


Figure 9: Integration region $R = [0, 1]^2$, the unit square.

The integrand is continuous on R , so Corollary 0.2 applies and either order of integration yields the same value.

Integrating y first, then x :

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}[g(X, Y)] &= \int_0^1 \int_0^1 (x^2 + y^2) dy dx \\
&= \int_0^1 \left[x^2 y + \frac{y^3}{3} \right]_0^1 dx \\
&= \int_0^1 \left(x^2 + \frac{1}{3} \right) dx \\
&= \left[\frac{x^3}{3} + \frac{x}{3} \right]_0^1 \\
&= \frac{2}{3}
\end{aligned}$$

Integrating x first, then y (verifying the order can be swapped):

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_0^1 \int_0^1 (x^2 + y^2) dx dy &= \int_0^1 \left[\frac{x^3}{3} + y^2 x \right]_0^1 dy \\
&= \int_0^1 \left(\frac{1}{3} + y^2 \right) dy \\
&= \left[\frac{y}{3} + \frac{y^3}{3} \right]_0^1 \\
&= \frac{2}{3}
\end{aligned}$$

Both orders give $\frac{2}{3}$, as Corollary 0.2 guarantees.

As a cross-check, linearity of expectation gives the same value: since $\mathbb{E}[X^2] = \int_0^1 x^2 dx = \frac{1}{3}$ for $X \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 1)$ (and likewise for Y),

$$\mathbb{E}[g(X, Y)] = \mathbb{E}[X^2 + Y^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] + \mathbb{E}[Y^2] = \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{3} = \frac{2}{3}.$$

The solid whose volume equals this integral is shown in Figure 10.

(This 3D surface is interactive; see the HTML or slide version of this page to view it.)

Figure 10: Surface $z = x^2 + y^2$ over the unit square $[0, 1]^2$. The double integral $\frac{2}{3}$ is the volume between this surface and the xy -plane, and equals $\mathbb{E}[X^2 + Y^2]$.

Theorem 0.15 (Fubini–Tonelli theorem (measure-theoretic form)). *Let $(\Omega_1, \mathcal{F}_1, \mu_1)$ and $(\Omega_2, \mathcal{F}_2, \mu_2)$ be [measure spaces](#) with [\$\sigma\$ -finite](#) measures, and let $f : \Omega_1 \times \Omega_2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be [measurable](#) with respect to the [product \$\sigma\$ -algebra](#) $\mathcal{F}_1 \otimes \mathcal{F}_2$. If either*

- (a) *$f \geq 0$ [almost everywhere](#) with respect to the [product measure](#) $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ (**Tonelli's theorem**), or*

(b) $\int_{\Omega_1 \times \Omega_2} |f| d(\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2) < \infty$, that is, f is *absolutely integrable* (**Fubini's theorem**),

then both iterated *integrals* exist, agree with the double integral, and equal each other:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\Omega_1 \times \Omega_2} f d(\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2) &= \int_{\Omega_1} \left(\int_{\Omega_2} f(\omega_1, \omega_2) d\mu_2(\omega_2) \right) d\mu_1(\omega_1) \\ &= \int_{\Omega_2} \left(\int_{\Omega_1} f(\omega_1, \omega_2) d\mu_1(\omega_1) \right) d\mu_2(\omega_2). \end{aligned}$$

(Billingsley 1995, Theorem 18.3; Gut 2013, Theorem 9.1, p. 65; Fubini 1907; Wikipedia contributors 2024)

Remark 0.2 (Fubini–Tonelli for probability measures). Applied courses rarely need the measure-theoretic generalization itself, but it is what justifies the *joint-distribution form* corollary in *Probability for Data Science*. A *probability measure* P on Ω has $P(\Omega) = 1 < \infty$, so it is *finite*, and hence σ -finite (*finite and σ -finite measures*); for probability measures, the σ -finiteness condition is automatic.

The integrability conditions (nonnegativity or *absolute integrability*) still need to be verified in each application. For example, *Lebesgue measure* (ordinary length) on $[0, 1]$ is a probability measure, so the σ -finiteness condition holds for both factors $[0, 1]$, yet the two iterated integrals in Example 0.27 are $\pi/4$ and $-\pi/4$. So σ -finiteness alone does not make the iterated integrals agree.

Example 0.29 (Positive application of Theorem 0.15). Let X and Y be independent Exponential(1) *random variables*, with *joint density* $f(x, y) = e^{-(x+y)}$ for $x, y \geq 0$.

The probability $P(X \leq 1, Y \leq 1)$ is the integral of f over $[0, 1]^2$ with respect to Lebesgue measure (ordinary length) in each coordinate. Lebesgue measure on $[0, \infty)$ is σ -finite, because $[0, \infty)$ is the union of the intervals $[0, n]$, $n \in \mathbb{N}$, each of finite length n ; so the σ -finiteness condition of Theorem 0.15 holds. Since $f(x, y) = e^{-(x+y)} \geq 0$, condition (a) (Tonelli's theorem, nonnegativity) is also satisfied.

By Theorem 0.15, both iterated integrals exist and agree. Integrating y first, then x :

$$\begin{aligned}
P(X \leq 1, Y \leq 1) &= \int_0^1 \int_0^1 e^{-(x+y)} dy dx \\
&= \int_0^1 \int_0^1 e^{-x} e^{-y} dy dx && \text{(exponential of a sum)} \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-x} \left(\int_0^1 e^{-y} dy \right) dx && (e^{-x} \text{ is constant in } y) \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-x} [-e^{-y}]_{y=0}^{y=1} dx && \text{(antiderivative of } e^{-y}) \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-x} (1 - e^{-1}) dx && \text{(evaluate at the limits)} \\
&= (1 - e^{-1}) \int_0^1 e^{-x} dx && (1 - e^{-1} \text{ is constant in } x) \\
&= (1 - e^{-1}) [-e^{-x}]_{x=0}^{x=1} && \text{(antiderivative of } e^{-x}) \\
&= (1 - e^{-1})^2 && \text{(evaluate at the limits)}
\end{aligned}$$

Integrating x first, then y :

$$\begin{aligned}
P(X \leq 1, Y \leq 1) &= \int_0^1 \int_0^1 e^{-(x+y)} dx dy \\
&= \int_0^1 \int_0^1 e^{-y} e^{-x} dx dy && \text{(exponential of a sum)} \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-y} \left(\int_0^1 e^{-x} dx \right) dy && (e^{-y} \text{ is constant in } x) \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-y} [-e^{-x}]_{x=0}^{x=1} dy && \text{(antiderivative of } e^{-x}) \\
&= \int_0^1 e^{-y} (1 - e^{-1}) dy && \text{(evaluate at the limits)} \\
&= (1 - e^{-1}) \int_0^1 e^{-y} dy && (1 - e^{-1} \text{ is constant in } y) \\
&= (1 - e^{-1}) [-e^{-y}]_{y=0}^{y=1} && \text{(antiderivative of } e^{-y}) \\
&= (1 - e^{-1})^2 && \text{(evaluate at the limits)}
\end{aligned}$$

Both iterated integrals equal $(1 - e^{-1})^2 \approx 0.400$, as Theorem 0.15 guarantees when condition (a) holds.

Example 0.30 (When neither Fubini–Tonelli condition is satisfied). The same function $f(x, y) = (x^2 - y^2)/(x^2 + y^2)^2$ from Example 0.27 illustrates a case where neither condition of Theorem 0.15 is satisfied.

Why Theorem 0.15’s conditions fail: $\iint_R |f| dA = \infty$, which violates condition (b). Switching to polar coordinates (r, θ) near the origin, the integrand satisfies $|f(x, y)| = |x^2 - y^2|/(x^2 + y^2)^2 = |\cos 2\theta|/r^2$, so

$$\begin{aligned}\iint_R |f| dA &\geq \int_0^{\pi/2} \int_0^\epsilon \frac{|\cos 2\theta|}{r^2} r dr d\theta \\ &= \left(\int_0^{\pi/2} |\cos 2\theta| d\theta \right) \int_0^\epsilon \frac{dr}{r} \\ &= +\infty,\end{aligned}$$

since $\int_0^\epsilon dr/r$ diverges. Therefore $\iint_R |f| dA = \infty$, and condition (b) of Theorem 0.15 is not satisfied. (Condition (a) also fails: f takes both positive and negative values, so it is not nonnegative a.e.) The unequal iterated integrals from Example 0.27 are thus consistent with Theorem 0.15: the theorem simply does not apply. (Wikipedia contributors 2024)

Further reading

- Kaplan (2022)
- Khuri (2003)
- Banner (2007)
- Larson and Edwards (2018)
- Miller (2016)
 - <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xYzQL0TUtBA>
 - http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ps2SBo_WjoE
- Grinberg (2017) (the rigorous foundations behind these results)

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